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*** Not an actual NSF award. Names, numbers and terms are invented. ***

NATIONAL SCIENCE FOUNDATION (SYNTHETIC)
NOTICE OF RESEARCH GRANT AWARD AND AGREEMENT

Award Number: USC-NSF-2026-0142
Recipient Organization: University of Southern California (synthetic example)
Principal Investigator: Dr. Avery Example, Department of Civil and Environmental Engineering
Project Title: Low-Cost Spectroscopic Monitoring of Urban Watersheds

The National Science Foundation (the "Foundation") hereby awards a grant to the Recipient Organization for support of the project described in the proposal referenced above. This agreement incorporates the Foundation’s general research terms and conditions and the cost principles set out in 2 CFR Part 200, as supplemented below.

1. PERIOD OF PERFORMANCE

The award supports work conducted during the period of performance beginning January 1, 2026 and ending December 31, 2026. Costs incurred before the start date or after the end date are not allowable charges to this award unless the Grants Officer authorizes them in writing, including any pre-award costs or no-cost extension.

2. APPROVED BUDGET

The Foundation approves the following direct cost budget. Amounts are the maximum the Recipient may charge to each category without further approval, subject to the re-budgeting provisions in Section 4.

Budget Category	Approved Amount
Personnel	$180,000.00
Fringe	$54,000.00
Equipment	$25,000.00
Travel	$8,000.00
Materials & Supplies	$6,000.00
Subawards	$60,000.00
Participant Support	$10,000.00
Total Direct Costs	$343,000.00

Participant support costs are restricted to stipends, travel and subsistence for workshop participants and may not be re-budgeted into other categories without prior written approval.

3. INDIRECT COSTS

Indirect costs (facilities and administrative costs, "F&A") are awarded at the Recipient’s negotiated rate of 26% of modified total direct costs (MTDC). For this award, MTDC excludes equipment, participant support costs, rental costs, tuition remission, scholarships, patient care, and the portion of each subaward in excess of the first $50,000. The Recipient must apply this rate consistently and may not recover indirect costs on excluded items.

4. RE-BUDGETING AND PRIOR APPROVAL

The Recipient may re-budget among direct cost categories to meet project needs. Prior approval from the Grants Officer is required where the cumulative amount of such transfers exceeds ten percent of the total approved budget, consistent with 2 CFR 200.308.

5. UNALLOWABLE COSTS

Costs of alcoholic beverages and entertainment, including tickets to shows or sports events, are unallowable and may not be charged to this award directly or indirectly.

6. PAYMENT

Funds will be drawn down through the Foundation’s payment system. Cumulative drawdowns must reconcile to allowable costs recorded in the Recipient’s accounting system.

Signed for the Foundation: (synthetic) Grants and Agreements Officer